

**Parishes of Camus, Clonleigh and Leckpatrick
Eighteenth Sunday in Ordinary Time – Year A – 2nd August 2026**

Parish Clergy

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Thoughts on the Gospel (Matthew 14:13-21)

The miracle of the loaves and fishes began with **compassion**. Jesus first noticed the crowd's pain before providing for their hunger. In our busy lives, God invites us to see those who are lonely, discouraged, or forgotten. Even small acts of kindness can become someone's miracle.

The disciples focused on what they lacked, yet Jesus asked them to offer what they *did* have. God rarely asks for what we do not possess. When we offer our time, talents, and resources — however small — He multiplies them in ways we cannot imagine.

Before the food was shared, Jesus surrendered everything to the Father. We too carry burdens that feel heavy, but surrender is not giving up; it is trusting God with our limitations. What seems insufficient to us becomes more than enough in His hands. The abundance left over reminds us that God's blessings are meant to flow *through* us. When we share generously, encourage others, and forgive freely, His grace continues to multiply.

***Lord, fill us with compassion, use what little we offer, and multiply it for Your glory.
Teach us to trust You and to share Your blessings generously. Amen.***

Monthly Mass in Honour of St Pio will be celebrated on Wednesday 5th August at 7.00 pm in Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane. We ask God's blessing on all through the intercession of St Pio. Everyone welcome.

Due to the Current Holiday Period, we wish to notify parishioners that there will be no newsletter until 22nd/23rd August. Apologies for any inconvenience. The office will be open as follows for the following two weeks: 10 am - 2 pm, Monday - Friday. Normal hours will resume on Monday 17th August.

The Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary

Saturday 15th August is the Feast of the Assumption of the Blessed Virgin Mary and is a holy day of obligation. On this feast, we recall Mary's role in the life of Jesus and in salvation. Mass times for the holy day are as follows:

Vigil Mass on Friday 14th August at 6.30 pm in Immaculate Conception Church

Mass on Saturday 15th August at 8.30 am in Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

Mass on Saturday 15th August at 10.00 am in St Patrick's Church, Murlog.

Masses at the usual times on the evening of Saturday 15th & Sunday 16th August.

Prayer at Time of Exam Results

Dear Lord, in this moment of uncertainty, I seek Your peace and guidance.
Help me to accept the results of my efforts with grace, whether they meet my hopes or not. Grant me the strength to learn and grow from this experience, trusting in Your plan for my life. May I find comfort in Your love and wisdom.
May Your peace fill my heart as I walk forward in faith. Amen.

Requiescant in Pace We offer our sympathy to the family and friends of Harry Mullen, Victoria Rd, Strabane; Bernie Greene, Tipperary.

Anniversaries Tony Boggs, Joseph Colhoun, Willie Curran, May Doherty, Johnny Forbes, Charlie Gallagher, Johnny Gallagher, Kevin Gallagher, Mary Gallagher, Nellie Gallagher, David Kennedy, Susan Lafferty, Anne Maguire, Bernard McDermott, Laurence McDermott, Emmett McGhee, Thomas McGranaghan, James O'Neill, Martin Stevenson, Vincent Sweeney, James McDermott (60th anniversary), Margaret McCay, Anna Morgan. May they rest in peace.

9.45am Mass on Sundays in Murlog Chapel is live on Finn Valley Community Radio.

Thank You for your generosity to last week's collections:

Leckpatrick: £1,372.61;

Clonleigh: €1,925.66;

Camus: £1,420.06.

Thanks to those who pay by standing order.

Readings for Sunday 9th August:

1st Reading: First Kings 19: 9a, 11-13a

Psalm: 85: 9, 10, 11-12, 13-14

2nd Reading: Romans 9: 1-5

Gospel: Matthew 14: 22-33

Readings 15th August (Feast of the Assumption):

1st Reading: Revelation 11: 19a; 12: 1-6a, 10ab

Psalm: 45: 10, 11, 12, 16

2nd Reading: 1st Corinthians 15: 20-27;

Gospel: Luke 1: 39-56

Readings for Sunday 16th August:

1st Reading: Isaiah 56: 1, 6-7

Psalm: 67: 2-3, 5, 6, 8

2nd Reading: Romans 11: 13-15, 29-32

Gospel: Matthew 15: 21-28

Readings for Sunday 23rd August:

1st Reading: Isaiah 22: 19-23

Psalm: 137: 1-3, 6, 8

2nd Reading: Romans 11: 33-36

Gospel: Matthew 16: 13-20

Saints of The Coming Week:

Tuesday: St John Vianney, priest;

Wed: The Dedication of the Basilica of St Mary Major in Rome;

Thurs: The Transfiguration of the Lord;

Fri: St Cajetan, priest; St Sixtus II, pope, & companions, martyrs;

Sat: St Dominic, priest

Embrace the Grace Legion of Mary Young Adult (18-40) Catholic Conference takes place on Sat 29th August from 9.30 am - 6 pm at De Montfort House, Morning Star Ave, Dublin, D07 VA03. Tickets from www.eventbrite. Search Embrace the Grace.

Pope's Prayer Intention for August *For evangelisation in the city*

Let us pray that in large cities often marked by anonymity and loneliness we find new ways to proclaim the Gospel, discovering creative paths to build community.

Rosary on the Coast takes place today (Sunday) at 3.00 pm at Lisfannon Beach, praying for peace, Ireland and our unborn children. Everyone welcome.

Give Blood, Save Lives NI Blood Transfusion Service will collect blood donations at Lisneal College, 70 Crescent Link, Derry, BT47 5FQ on 4th August from 1230 pm - 4.00 pm & 5.00 pm - 7.30 pm. Please freecall 08085534653 to book.

Lough Derg Annual Fundraising Draw to ensure Station Island remains open for future generations. Single ticket: €10. Book of 6: €50. Buy a full book and you're entered into a sellers' draw. Return a complete book for Early Bird draws on 28/8/26. Tickets from www.loughderg.org/store/c3/annualdraw or +353 (0) 719861518 or info@loughderg.org Prizes: 1st: €10,000, 2nd: €5,000, 3rd: €2,000, 4th: €1,500, 5th: €1,000, 6th: €500. Draw date: 23rd October 2026.

Job Opportunity Derry Diocesan Trust invites applications for the post of Administrative & Financial Officer at Clonmany Parish. 9 hours pw. For application pack, please contact Bishop's House, St Eugene's Cathedral, Derry, BT48 9AP, 02871262302 or recruitment@derrydiocese.org Closing date: 11th August 2026.

Franciscan Friary, Rossnowlagh Monthly Healing Service today (Sunday). Rosary at 2.45 pm followed by Mass / Healing Service at 3 pm. Confessions 2 - 5 pm.

ACCORD Derry Marriage Preparation Courses available at www.accordni.com

Monthly Mass in Memory of Sr Clare Crockett will be celebrated on Sunday 9th August at 7 pm in Carmelite Retreat Centre, Termonbacca, Derry.

Pray for Vocations We pray for men called to priesthood. Like Jesus in today's gospel, may they never turn away from the poor, hungry, most vulnerable or those in need, but always reflect the love of Christ as they nourish and strengthen them with the Word of God. Visit <https://derryvocations.org>

A Day of Healing & Prayer in the House of Prayer, Clonfert with Eddie Stone on Sat 15th August. A bus leaves Letterkenny, collecting people in Ballybofey and Donegal Town. A priest will accompany the group. Please contact 0863936547.

Sharing the Good News Visit <https://theway.ie/ezine-2/> for the weekly ezine.

Sean Davis 4 Day Outdoor Summer Fun Soccer Academy takes place at Templemore Sports Complex, Derry from 4th - 7th August. Boys and girls aged 5 - 18 welcome. Times: 10 am - 3 pm. Please contact Sean on 07787791880.

Youth 2000 Festival | 13th–16th August Calling all young people (16 - 35). Join us in Newbridge College, Kildare. Free buses. All meals included. Inspiring talks, workshops, Mass, music, prayer, and plenty of opportunities to chill out and meet other young Catholics. Visit youth2000.ie or follow @Youth2000Ireland

Family Carers Ireland are running 1:1 support clinics remotely every Tuesday in August for carers, offering you a space and time to talk over the phone in the comfort of your own home. Contact 0868363842 or Donegalcs@familycarers.ie

Lough Derg As the **3 Day Pilgrimage** season draws to a close soon (final day to start is 13th August), our **Day Retreats** recommence on August 18, 22, 23, 29 & 31 and September 5, 6, 9, 12, 15, 19, 20. Take time away from the busyness of life for a day of guided prayer, quiet reflection and spiritual renewal in the peaceful surroundings of Lough Derg. Booking essential. Please visit www.loughderg.org

Mary's Meals Annual Step by Step Walk takes place on Sunday 9th August at 12 noon from Sainsbury's car park, Strand Rd, Derry, walking around the Foyle Bridge & Peace Bridge. All welcome, even for a mile or two. Mary's Meals currently feeds over 3 million children a daily school meal across 16 countries. For further details / to register, please visit www.marysmeals.org.uk/step or contact Caoimhe on 07394564065. Please keep all our walkers in your prayers.

Donegal Pro Life Annual Church Gate Collection takes place on Saturday 15th / Sunday 16th August countywide. If you can help in taking up a collection, it would be appreciated. Please contact Margaret on 00353892469599. Míle buíochas.

The Monthly Pro Life Witness / Gathering takes place at the roundabout at Letterkenny Hospital on Friday 7th August from 1 pm - 2 pm. All welcome.

The Contemplative Prayer Group meets on Mondays at 8 pm in the Prayer Room in the Parochial House, Barrack St. All welcome.

Termonbacca Derry Anam Óg Summer Scheme for those aged 8 - 14 takes place from 3rd - 7th August from 12 - 4 pm daily. Faith, friendship, arts and crafts, adventures, games and prayer. Please email termonbaccaderry@ocd.ie

Walk in Our Patron Saint's Footsteps St Patrick's Way Pilgrim Walk, Downpatrick with guides Martina Purdy & Elaine Kelly on **8th August 9 am - 3 pm** Cost (£55). Tel 028 44619000. Visit www.saintpatrickcentre.com

Reflections Through Poetry book by Fr John P Forbes available in Pastoral Office. Cost: £10. Proceeds to Children in Crossfire and Cause for Sr Clare's Canonisation.

Parish Bingo & Lucky Four A warm welcome to all to St Pat's Hall every Thursday at 8 pm. Come along for some fun, excitement and slight competition.

Strabane / Leckpatrick Draw July 2026

Prize	Winner	Promoter
£2,000	Philomena & Bosco Gallagher	Siobhan McDevitt
£1,000	Pat Gallagher	Sadie Kerlin
£500	Fr Paul Farren	Fr Michael
£500	Conal Doherty	Colette McKane
£250	Paddy Quinn	Fr Michael
£250	Brian Devine	Gabrielle Dooher
£100	Finola Kerr	Nuala Kerr
£100	Laura Burke	Paul Mullen
£100	Steven Casey	Paul Mullen
£100	Mary Barrett	Patsy Barrett
£100	Sarah McMichael	Ann McCrory

Congratulations to all the winners. Thank you for your support.

Weekend Mass Schedule

Immaculate Conception: Saturday Vigil: **4.30 pm**; Sunday: **11.00 am**

Sacred Heart, Derry Road: Sunday: **12.15 pm**

St Patrick's, Clonleigh: Saturday Vigil: **6.30 pm**; Sunday: **9.45 am**

St Joseph's, Glenmornan: Sunday: **8.30 am** (2nd August - alternate Sundays - 16th August)

St Mary's, Cloughcor: Sunday: **8.30 am** (9th August - alternate Sundays - 23rd August)

Weekday Mass Schedule

Monday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Tuesday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Wednesday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

(followed by **Eucharistic Adoration** until 5.30 pm).

10.00 am: St Patrick's Church, Lifford

Thursday: **10.00 am:** Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Friday: **8.00 am:** Sacred Heart Church, Derry Road

10.00 am: Immaculate Conception Church, Strabane

Weddings Please contact the parish office. At least 6 months' notice required.

Baptisms: Parent(s) are asked to contact the parish office.

The Parish Pastoral Area Office, 27 Butcher St, Strabane covers all 3 parishes.

Office hours: Monday – Thursday: 9.30 am - 4.30 pm; Friday: 9.30 am - 12.30 pm.

Please feel free to call in or phone on 028 7188 2215.

Reminder that the deadline for parish bulletin notices is 2 pm on Wednesdays.

A Small Collection of Candles is available for purchase at the Pastoral Office.

A gentle reminder that we can only accept cash or cheque payments. Thank you.

Safeguarding (Northern Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Adult at risk of harm or Adult in need of protection within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on 07596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact PSNI on 101, Western HSCT Children's Gateway Services on 028 71 314090, WHSCT Adult Gateway Services on 028 71 611366 or the Regional Emergency Social Work Service on 028 95 049999.

Safeguarding (Republic of Ireland) If you have any concerns with regard to the Safeguarding of Children or Vulnerable Adults within the Church please contact Marie Gormley, the Diocesan Designated Liaison Person (DLP) on +44 7596 500793 or at marie.gormley@derrydiocese.org To report a safeguarding suspicion, concern, knowledge or allegation directly to the statutory authorities please contact Garda Síochána Buncrana on 074 93 20540, Garda Síochána Letterkenny on 074 91 67100, TUSLA (ROI) Child and Family Agency on 074 91 02233 or HSC Adult Safeguarding, Donegal on 071 983 4660.